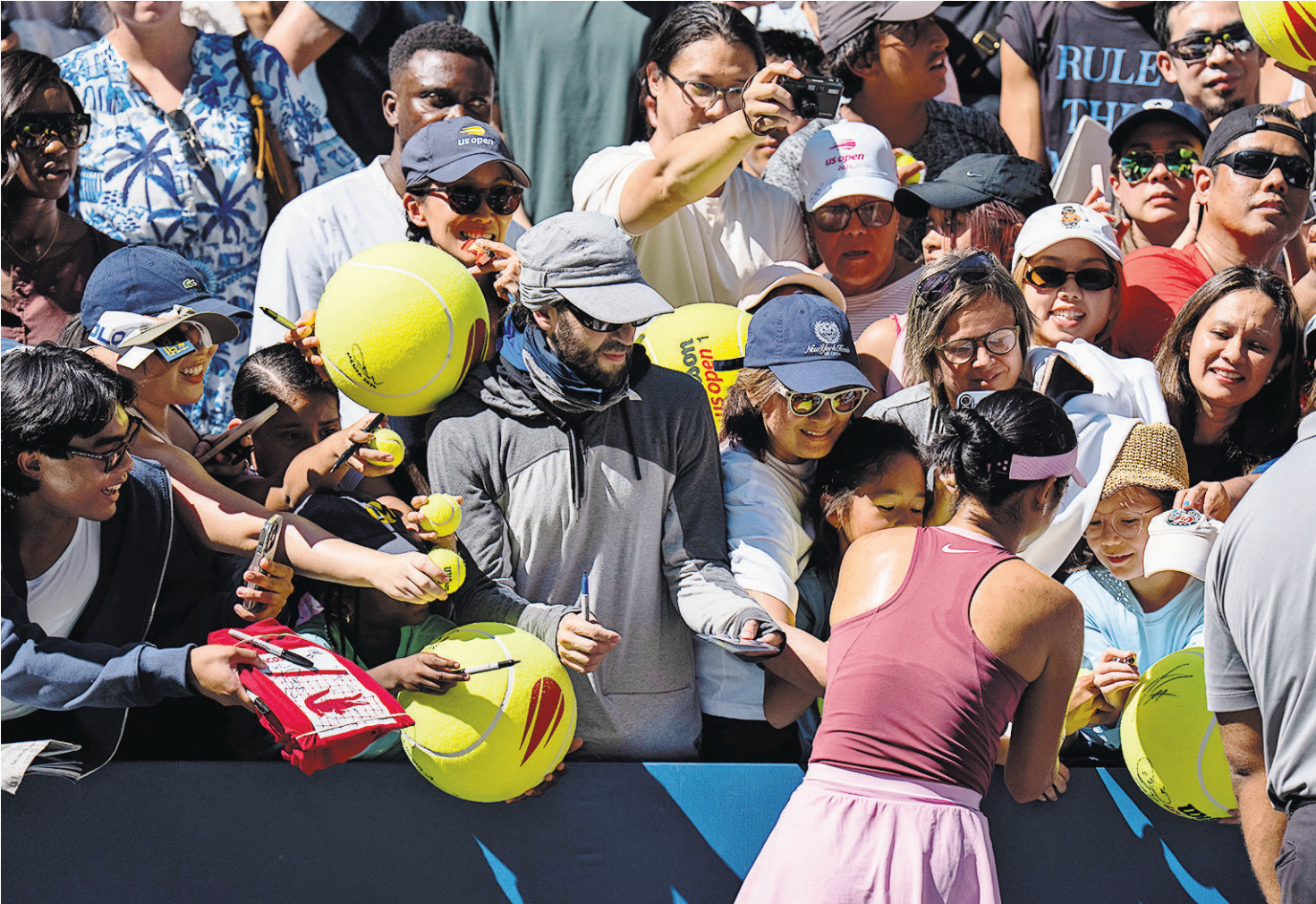




HIROKO MASUIKE/THE NEW YORK TIMES

“Facebook, Instagram, even in church, people are talking about her,” one fan said of Alex Eala, 21, who won a tournament last month.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Iran Strategy
Enters Reruns

After 6 Months of War,
Trump Goes in Circles

By ERICA L. GREEN

WASHINGTON — As the on-again, off-again war in Iran flares up again, President Trump seems bogged down in a conflict that he cannot control or move past, despite his declarations of total victory.

On Tuesday night, after the latest exchange of fire over control of the Strait of Hormuz, Mr. Trump called on the Iranian people to rise up — something he did at the outset of the war six months ago, before he acknowledged that his command was easier said than done.

In a social media post, Mr. Trump also brushed off the stalled negotiations with Iran.

“I couldn’t care less if they sign a worthless, to them, agreement,” he wrote on Tuesday night, hours after the United States carried out a fresh wave of attacks and Iran hit back.

“I like our position now much better, with almost total control of the Hormuz Strait, and their economy totally collapsing,” Mr. Trump continued. “They are just playing out the inevitable. When are the Iranian people going to rise up and fight?”

The post followed a 24-hour stretch during which Mr. Trump’s by-now familiar playbook for the conflict was on full display. The president went from boasting that Iran was defeated militarily, a “failed nation” in economic disarray, to threatening an apocalyptic attack that would leave “very little left” of the country after it had defied his declarations and demands.

By Wednesday morning, as Iran and the United States assessed the damage of the most recent attacks, Mr. Trump was back to trolling the country on social media, asking his followers whether the United States should name the Strait of Hormuz the “Trump Strait.”

Foreign policy experts say the latest round of hostilities point to a reality that has become increasingly clear of Mr. Trump’s handling of the war: He has run out of options.

“The strategy has been rinse and repeat, whether it’s rhetorical or kinetic action,” said

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In Little Manila, This U.S. Open Redefines Love

By HILARY HOWARD

Little Manila, a one-block thicket of restaurants and businesses in Woodside, Queens, is the heart and soul of Filipino culture in New York City. Here, momentum is building in the quiet micro-neighborhood, just a 10-minute subway ride from the boisterous U.S. Open, as Alex Eala, the young Filipino tennis star, starts her long-shot run to win one of the largest and most lucrative tennis tournaments in the world.

At a pop-up food market in Little Manila last weekend, while rice cakes and barbecue cooked over hot coals on the sidewalks, the cheerful response among Filipino New Yorkers, upon being asked if they knew about Eala, was nearly

A Queens Community
Unites Behind Eala,
a Filipino Star

universal: “Of course!”

Llalen Cruzat, who was giving out free samples of kapeng barako, a bold Philippine coffee, said she had been seeing and hearing Eala’s name everywhere. “Facebook, Instagram, even in church, people are talking about her.”

Eala has reached icon status among Filipinos. Last month, the left-handed 21-year-old became the first tennis player from the Philippines — man or woman — to win a major singles title. But for

Filipinos, she is not simply an ambassador for the sport. Her success is giving the country, a large, dispersed archipelago of more than 7,000 islands in Southeast Asia, as well as its diaspora, a reason to unite.

“She’s the perfect representation of a Filipino lady,” said Sharmaine Rivera, 47, an occupational therapist from Elmhurst, Queens. Rivera had attended an early Eala exhibition match at the Billie Jean King National Tennis Center in nearby Flushing, the home of the Open, and it was packed with Fil-

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A NEW YORK BONANZA Is the Open the most valuable sports entity in the city? PAGE B6



IVOR PRICKETT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Israeli flags next to Palestinian farms in the West Bank, part of a violent intimidation campaign.

Seeing West Bank Settlers as Risk to Israel Itself

This article is by Azam Ahmed, Natan Odenheimer and Ronen Bergman.

Maj. Gen. Eyal Ben-Reuven spent his life fighting for Israel. He survived the Arab-Israeli war of 1973, when his platoon was nearly wiped out, then went on to command a division in the West Bank and lead Israel’s ground forces in the 2006 war against Hezbollah.

But in recent months, he has returned to the Israeli-occupied West Bank, touring the territory

Ex-Generals Are Among
Israelis Voicing Fears

with retired generals and former Israeli officials like himself. He has walked through the remains of a Palestinian school looted by Israeli settlers, and listened to Palestinian shepherds and farmers describe being tortured by settlers who seize their livestock and land.

Now, General Ben-Reuven says he has an entirely different understanding of the risks facing Israel today.

“This, what the settlers are doing here, is the real threat to Israel,” he said, his eyes welling with emotion. “This is more concerning to me than Iran, Gaza or Lebanon.”

Other former high-ranking Israeli officials touring the West Bank with him shared the same indignation.

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Administration Pulling
Agents From Usual Jobs
To Examine Voter Rolls

Hunt for Noncitizens May Violate Privacy

By NICK CORASANITI and HAMED ALEAZIZ

Hundreds of federal agents from the Department of Homeland Security have been assigned to an intensive, weekslong hunt for noncitizens among the nation’s registered voters despite an absence of evidence of widespread fraud, according to documents and training videos reviewed by The New York Times.

Agents are scouring voter rolls managed by the states, and are using personally identifiable information about individual voters, such as their dates of birth and partial Social Security numbers, to look them up on those rolls, according to the documents.

In some cases, investigators are effectively posing as individual voters by plugging their names and personal information into public-facing websites run by the top election official in each state. Some of these sites declare they are meant for individual use, potentially raising privacy concerns.

The extraordinary operation reveals the extent to which the Trump administration is searching for evidence of fraud ahead of the November elections. The government is privately calling the ef-

fort the Unlawful Voter Initiative and is pulling agents from their normal duties, which include investigating such serious crimes as human trafficking and terrorism.

Given the decades of evidence showing how rare noncitizen voting is, it’s unclear what the administration will discover, how verifiable any findings will be and what President Trump or Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin plans to do with those findings. A database managed by the conservative Heritage Foundation identifies roughly 100 instances of noncitizen voting over a quarter-century. More recently, roughly 400 noncitizens — a tiny fraction of the electorate — voted in New Jersey after a software glitch led to their improper registration.

Mr. Trump has falsely claimed since his defeat in 2020 that fraud is epidemic in U.S. elections. This year, he has focused heavily on noncitizen voting, calling it a “crisis of election security” in a speech in July and regularly making unsubstantiated claims that

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As the Met Embraced Galliano,
Powerful Patrons Pushed Back

This article is by Jacob Bernstein, Vanessa Friedman and Dana Rubinstein.

Early last month, Anna Wintour, the global editorial director of Vogue and powerful Metropolitan Museum of Art trustee, reached out to Julie Menin, the daughter of a Holocaust survivor and the first Jewish speaker of the New York City Council.

Over a 30-minute video call, Wintour tried to persuade Menin that honoring John Galliano, the fashion designer convicted of an antisemitic hate crime, with a solo exhibition in the Met’s Costume Institute was a good idea.

Galliano is a creative genius, Wintour said, according to Menin. And he is contrite about his previous rants against Jews — which included an exclamation of “I love Hitler!” and a taunting of patrons at a bar that their forefathers would all be “gassed.”

During the call, Wintour, who rules over the fashion world and the Met Gala with almost unques-



VALERIE PLESCH FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Anna Wintour had personally championed a designer’s show.

tioned authority, offered to have Galliano meet privately with Menin. She also, according to Wintour’s spokeswoman, discussed possible ways to mollify critics of the show, such as moving the date of the gala, changing its focus and opening the exhibition early for Jewish leaders.

Menin left the call feeling brushed off. Wintour had continued to exude confidence that the

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Home Survives Nepal’s Floods,
And in Turn, Rescues a Family

By MUJIB MASHAL and BINOD GHIMIRE

DHUNGE BAZAAR, Nepal — For some, it’s become known as the “miracle” green house. For others arriving to stare in wonderment and take selfies, it is simply “the viral house.”

When a ferocious torrent of water, mud and debris swept away nearly everything in its path in Nepal last week, it created a whirlpool of destruction around the Pyakurel family home in Dhunge Bazaar. A video spread far and wide on social media, showing the family helplessly looking down from their third-floor balcony at the angry deluge slamming against their home, the waves trying to lap them up.

But the house stood firm. Chhatra Bahadur Pyakurel, 67, said he had just dropped his



FRANCIS MASCARENHAS/REUTERS

A building in Nepal is now the “miracle” green house.

grandson off at the school bus and returned home when the floods — caused by a massive glacier collapse in the Himalayan region between Nepal and Tibet — reached their home.

For over an hour, all the family

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Fighting a Flesh-Eating Fly

Mexico races to combat a major screw-worm infestation, which has disrupted a strained cattle industry. PAGE A13

Irish Factory in Global Dispute

Alumina from a Russian-owned refinery in County Limerick may be feeding Moscow’s war in Ukraine. PAGE A4

NATIONAL A14-21

D.C. Makeover Faces Hurdles

Work on the president’s ballroom is proceeding, but some of his other Washington projects remain stalled. PAGE A14

Eradicating an Island’s Deer

The conservancy that owns most of Catalina Island in California wants to restore the natural ecosystem. PAGE A21

BUSINESS B1-5

Which Investors Will Win Big?

Start-up investing has changed a lot over the years and as Anthropic and OpenAI prepare to go public, just about everyone stands to profit. PAGE B1



ARTS C1-6

What Is ‘Narrative Art’?

The long-awaited Lucas Museum finally reveals its vision, with less “Star Wars” than you might expect. PAGE C1

Nobody’s Watching, So Dance

The creator of the crime drama “Furious” has women with complex emotions break into solo moves. PAGE C1

SPORTS B6-9, 12

Woods Loses License for 5 Years

The golf star will avoid jail time after pleading no contest to two reduced charges in a D.U.I. case in Florida stemming from a March crash that caused his vehicle to roll over. PAGE B12

Searching for the Next Indiana

The Hoosiers’ transformation was so astounding that finding the next woebegone program to achieve national prominence feels nearly impossible. But we’ll give it a try anyway. PAGE B9

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Michelle Goldberg

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Jackie O’s Beach Is Open to All

But it’s a hike, part of a Martha’s Vineyard preserve with woodland trails and a 25-minute walk to the ocean. It comes with some caveats. PAGE D6



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